THE

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT PLAYBOOK

FOR MALAYSIAN TECHNICAL SERVICES COMPANIES

Condition Monitoring · Testing & Inspection · Maintenance · Engineering Consultancy

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Strategy · Sales Process · Client Psychology · Content Engine

Synthesised from
Rain Making (Ford Harding)
The Trusted Advisor (Maister, Green & Galford)
The Platinum Rule (Alessandra & O'Connor)
They Ask, You Answer (Marcus Sheridan)
Built to Sell (John Warrillow)

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SECTION 1: THE GROWTH ENGINE

Every professional services business runs on one formula, whether the founder knows it or not:

$$\text{Revenue} = N \times B \times F$$

This formula structures everything in this playbook. Every activity you do, every meeting you take, every article you write should improve at least one of these three variables. Growing all three simultaneously creates geometric growth.

What Each Variable Means

- **N (Network Size):** Facility managers, plant managers, operations heads, and building owners who know your company exists. For most early-stage technical services companies, this sits around 50–80. Target: 200–300.
- **B (% Buyers):** The percentage of your network who actually give you a purchase order. For young companies with early-stage relationships, this is typically 2–3%. Target: 5–8% through deeper trust and better qualification.
- **F (Average Fee):** Your average project value. Many technical services companies undercharge because they sell individual jobs instead of programmes. Moving from one-off projects to annual contracts or multi-site programmes can double or triple this number.

The Compound Effect

Scenario	Network (N)	Buyers (B)	Avg Fee (F)	Revenue
Current state	70	2.5%	RM 25,000	RM 43,750
12-month target	250	6.5%	RM 65,000	RM 1,056,250

Same founder. Same team. Same expertise. The difference is a system that deliberately grows all three variables instead of hoping the phone rings.

The Trust Equation

Trust is the mechanism that converts N into B. People buy from professionals they trust. The trust equation tells you exactly what to build:

$$\text{Trust} = (\text{Credibility} + \text{Reliability} + \text{Intimacy}) \div \text{Self-Orientation}$$

- **Credibility:** Your qualifications, certifications, client portfolio, published work, professional endorsements.

- **Reliability:** Do you deliver when you say you will? Consistency in small things builds enormous trust.
- **Intimacy:** Does the client feel safe telling you the real problem?
- **Self-Orientation (keep LOW):** Is your first instinct "how do I upsell?" or "what does this client actually need?" The client can feel the difference.

> *Key insight: Most firms over-invest in Credibility while ignoring Intimacy and Self-Orientation. The firms that win aren't always the most qualified — they're the ones clients trust most.*

How Trust Gets Weighted by Personality

Style	Trusts Through	Your Approach
Director (fast-paced, task-focused)	Credibility + Reliability	Be concise. Deliver results. Don't waste their time.
Socialiser (fast-paced, people-focused)	Intimacy + Credibility	Build personal rapport. Show enthusiasm. Be visible.
Relater (slow-paced, people-focused)	Intimacy + Reliability	Be patient. Don't rush. Show you care personally.
Thinker (slow-paced, task-focused)	Credibility (data-heavy)	Provide evidence. Be thorough. Let them analyse.

Four Layers, One Playbook

This document integrates four frameworks into a single workflow. After this page, the book labels disappear:

- **Layer 1 — The System:** What activities to do and when. How to structure your pipeline. How to grow N × B × F. (Rain Making)
- **Layer 2 — The Philosophy:** Who to be in every interaction. Show don't claim. Listen before solving. Build trust through the equation. (The Trusted Advisor)
- **Layer 3 — The Personalisation:** How to deliver Layer 1 using Layer 2 calibrated to each person's behavioural style. Director gets it fast. Thinker gets it thorough. Relater gets it patient. (The Platinum Rule)
- **Layer 4 — The Content Engine:** What to publish, where to distribute, and how to use content as a sales tool. Become the most trusted teacher in your technical domain. (They Ask, You Answer)

SECTION 2: MINDSET & IDENTITY

Before tactics or strategy, rewire how you think about selling. This section is conversational because mindset isn't a checklist — it's something you internalise over time.

Sales = Survival (Founder Edition)

If you don't sell, the company doesn't exist. There's no senior partner to send you out into the market. There's no fallback. Whether you sell direct or through referral networks, you are the growth engine. The sooner you accept this as a core part of your professional identity, the sooner your practice starts growing.

Lack of Time Is No Excuse

You're an execution-heavy founder — site visits, reports, partnerships, proposals. You're genuinely busy. Everyone who succeeds at marketing is equally busy. The difference isn't available hours — it's what you treat as urgent versus important.

Delivering client work feels urgent because there's a deadline. Writing a LinkedIn article doesn't feel urgent because nobody's waiting. But that article, published consistently over six months, puts you in front of decision-makers who have never heard of your company.

The Numbers Game

You need to internalise specific ratios and track them:

- **Cold approaches to get one meeting:** ~15–20
- **Meetings to get one quote request:** ~3–5
- **Quotes to get one PO:** ~2–3

Work backward from your revenue target. If you want 2 new direct clients per quarter, and your conversion is 20 approaches per client, you need 40 approaches per quarter. That's about 3 per week. Completely manageable — but only if you do it consistently.

When you email 20 companies and get 2 responses, that's a 10% response rate — actually decent for cold outreach. The numbers are normal. Your feelings about them are what needs calibrating.

The Emotional Roller Coaster

The emotional swings are amplified because the company is yours, not just your job. When a big opportunity stalls, it feels like a referendum on your business. When work comes through a partner, it feels like a half-win.

When you lose, don't spiral — debrief, learn, move on. When you win, actually celebrate. Notice when a stalled deal affects your motivation for other outreach. Notice when a win makes you complacent about marketing. Both are traps.

Production Mindset vs Marketing Mindset

Stop Maximising Billable Time at the Expense of Marketing

The professional who always chooses billable work over marketing is optimising for this month at the expense of next quarter. The system exists — CRM, outreach templates, pipeline tracking — the question is whether you'll use it or find reasons not to.

Marketing Time Is Investment, Not Waste

On average, 70% of the buying decision is made before a prospect ever talks to the company. A decade ago that was 20–40%. It's trending toward 80–90%. This means the blog post, the LinkedIn article, the case study on your website — that's where the sale actually happens. The meeting just confirms a decision your content already influenced.

Content Never Sleeps

A blog post about your service costs works at midnight when a facility manager is researching options before a budget meeting. It works on public holidays. It teaches 1,000 people at once without asking anything in return. The time invested compounds in ways that meetings simply cannot.

You're Not a Pest

By touch 3 or 4 of your outreach sequence, your instinct will be "I'm bothering this person." That feeling is your production mindset projecting. Most people aren't annoyed by professional, courteous follow-up — they're just busy. The follow-up IS the professional service.

Selling IS Practising Your Profession

When you help a facility manager see that their aging equipment represents a quantifiable risk their current approach isn't addressing — that IS your technical expertise applied to problem definition. You're not "selling." You're applying everything you know to help someone understand a risk they couldn't see without you.

Porpoising and the Alice Trap

> *Porpoising: the radical swing from too much work to too little, caused by stop-start marketing. You get busy with delivery, marketing pauses, current projects end, you wake up to an empty pipeline. The fix: always have at least one marketing activity running, no matter how busy you are.*

> *The Alice Trap: getting so busy delivering that you never transition to selling. When current projects end, there's nothing behind them. Always have marketing underway, no matter how much delivery work is in progress.*

Your Credibility Stack

The trust equation has no “degree” component. Credibility is expertise plus presence. Your stack, in order of impact:

1. Professional Endorsements — registered engineer sign-off, third-party validation, independent certification. Stronger than a personal degree because it’s independent proof.
2. Domain-Specific Certifications — the credentials your buyers actually check for. Industry-recognised qualifications that prove you can do the work.
3. Client Portfolio — when a prospect hears recognised company names, their brain processes “credible” faster than any qualification.
4. Domain Knowledge Depth — be the most knowledgeable person in the room about your specialisation. When you explain technical concepts in a way that helps them understand their risk better than they did before, nobody is thinking about your diploma.
5. Visible Enthusiasm — when you light up talking about your technical domain, that passion is a credibility signal that can’t be faked.

> *When the qualification question comes up: state your experience, certifications, endorsements, and client list — then move on. Defensiveness is self-orientation.*

Sayings to Keep in Your Head

- “It’s about the client, not about me.”
- “Who am I thinking about right now?”
- “The answer is a better question.”
- “The problem is rarely what the client said it was at first.”
- “I don’t have to prove myself every 10 seconds.”
- “Relax — I know more than I think I know.”
- “Am I claiming trust or demonstrating it?”
- “If my gut tells me something’s wrong, talk about it.”

SECTION 3: GETTING KNOWN

One-to-many activities that build reputation and put your company on the radar. These grow N (network size) and, when executed well, also grow B (conversion rate) because credibility increases trust. The core principle: show, don't claim.

The Big 5: What to Write About (Forever)

Five types of content consistently drive the most traffic, leads, and trust. The paradox: as buyers, people obsess over these five topics before every major purchase. As businesses, most hide from them.

Topic	Why It Works	Example
Cost & Pricing	Every buyer researches cost first. The company that answers honestly wins trust.	"How Much Does a Condition Monitoring Programme Cost in Malaysia?"
Problems & Limitations	Addressing what can go wrong builds more trust than claiming everything is perfect.	"5 Limitations of Thermography (And When You Need Additional Testing)"
Comparisons	Buyers compare anyway. Be the one who helps them do it honestly.	"Thermography vs Partial Discharge Testing: Which Does Your Facility Need?"
Best in Class	People search "best" before every purchase. Own that conversation.	"What Makes the Best Condition Monitoring Programme? 7 Things to Look For"
Reviews	Honest assessments of methods, equipment, standards build authority.	"Our Honest Review of Online vs Offline PD Testing Methods"

For any service you offer, ask five questions: What does it cost? What are the problems? How does it compare to alternatives? Who's the best? What are the reviews? That generates dozens of topics on demand.

The Content Engine: Write Once, Distribute Everywhere

One blog post per week answering a Big 5 question. That single post becomes the source for every other channel:

- **Blog post:** The comprehensive piece. Lives on your website, builds SEO, discoverable by strangers searching two years from now. The only channel you fully own and control.
- **LinkedIn:** Retell the same topic as a story or perspective, native to the platform. Don't copy-paste — reframe with a punchy opening hook.
- **Facebook:** Same as LinkedIn version. Also share in relevant Malaysian industry groups where your buyers gather.

- **WhatsApp Channel:** Not the full post. Pull one insight and make it snackable. Links to the full blog post for depth. Read rates in Malaysia are 85–95%.
- **Quarterly email mailer:** Curate the best blog posts from the quarter into a single email.
- **Site visit handout:** Print or PDF your best blog posts. Send to prospects before meetings. The content already exists — zero extra effort.

One hour writing the blog post, one hour distributing across channels. Two hours total — that's your weekly marketing block. 50 posts in a year gives your company more published educational content than probably every competitor in your market combined.

> *Second layer: repurpose across time. The blog post written in March becomes a comparison table in a July proposal, feeds into the October budget planning mailer, and gets updated next February. Every piece of content has a 12-month lifecycle, not a 48-hour one.*

The Ostrich Trap

The ostrich strategy is burying your head in the sand when a topic feels uncomfortable. "We'd better not address pricing on the website. Let's wait until we're face-to-face." But when was the last time you looked up how much something costs and the company you searched didn't answer? You left their website and found someone who would.

The topics that feel most uncomfortable to address — cost, problems, limitations, honest comparisons — are precisely the topics your buyers are researching right now. The company that answers them builds trust. The company that hides from them loses traffic to the company that doesn't.

Writing & Publishing (Beyond Blog)

The blog is your primary channel. But some writing targets audiences the blog won't reach:

- IEM (Institution of Engineers Malaysia) publications
- MSOSH newsletter — safety angle, reaches HSE decision makers
- ASHRAE Malaysia chapter publications — healthcare and data centre angle
- FM industry publications — facility management buyers
- Your company blog with proper SEO

Speaking

Topics That Generate Leads

- "Asset Risk Scoring: A Practical Framework for Facility Managers"
- "Building a Condition Monitoring Programme from Zero"
- "Regulatory Compliance: What Malaysian Facilities Need to Know"

> *Give the speech → write up as blog post → distribute through the content engine (LinkedIn, Facebook, WhatsApp Channel, email). One effort, five outputs.*

Training Workshops as Lead Generation

- Limit to 15–20 attendees for quality interaction
- Use real (anonymised) case data from your projects
- One-on-one conversations during breaks
- Follow up within 48 hours with every attendee
- Track: who attended → who engaged → who has a need → opportunity in CRM

The Conversion Funnel

Training attendee → asks about their facility → diagnostic assessment (RM 15–25K) → annual programme (RM 30–60K) → multi-facility contract (RM 100K+).

Social Content That Builds Credibility

DON'T	DO
"We completed a survey at [client]. Contact us for your needs!"	"This is what a critical anomaly looks like in the field. This issue was weeks from causing a major failure. Most managers don't know this is happening inside their systems."

The first is advertising. The second demonstrates expertise. Your audience concludes you know what you're talking about without being told.

Direct Mail & Email (Quarterly Cadence)

Each quarter, curate the best Big 5 blog posts into a themed email:

- **Q1:** "2026 Compliance Checklist" — one-page reference tool every facility manager pins to their board
- **Q2:** Case study mailer — anonymised results showing problems caught and downtime prevented
- **Q3:** Regulatory update — changes in Malaysian regulations relevant to your audience
- **Q4:** "Planning Your 2027 Maintenance Budget" — timed to budget season

Every mailer gives something useful. None say "contact us." That's the "go first" principle.

SECTION 4: BUILDING & MAINTAINING YOUR NETWORK

Who You Need to Know

Category	Examples	Why They Matter
Direct Buyers	Facility managers, plant managers, engineering managers, building owners	They sign POs or approve budgets
Influencers	Technicians, maintenance staff, HSE officers	They recommend vendors to the buyer
Referral Partners	Complementary service providers, FM companies, insurance assessors	They encounter your prospects daily
Gatekeepers	Procurement officers, quantity surveyors, admin managers	They control access to decision-makers
Knowledge Sources	Industry consultants, association leaders, regulators	They tell you about opportunities early

Trade Associations

Join and get active. Volunteer for committees:

- IEM — volunteer for a technical committee. Meet facility engineers across industries
- MSOSH — safety angle gives access to HSE directors who influence purchasing
- ASHRAE Malaysia — building services engineers in healthcare and data centres
- FMM — manufacturing facility managers are your core buyers

Network Quality

Target 200–300 contacts. Assess each across four dimensions:

- **Purchasing power:** Can they hire you?
- **Access & influence:** Connected to decision-makers?
- **Information value:** Early opportunity intelligence?
- **Referral willingness:** Actively recommend you?

> *The Oscar Principle: always introduce people who can help each other. Connectors get called first.*

Style-Adapted Relationship Maintenance

Style	Maintenance Approach	Frequency

Director	Short, results-focused updates.	Monthly email, quarterly call
Socialiser	Social engagement. Comment on posts. Invite to events.	Bi-weekly touchpoint
Relater	Personal check-ins.	Monthly personal message
Thinker	Technical content. Research, data.	Quarterly deep-value email

SECTION 5: THE SALES PROCESS

Getting the Meeting

The 4-Touch Outreach Sequence

- **Touch 1 (Day 1):** LinkedIn connection — brief, specific, no pitch
- **Touch 2 (Day 2–3):** Email — value-focused
- **Touch 3 (Day 4–5):** WhatsApp — conversational, brief
- **Touch 4 (Day 7–10):** Phone call — now warm

> *"I noticed [Company] recently expanded operations. Facilities with increased load often see accelerated wear on critical systems. Would 15 minutes be useful to share what we've seen work in similar situations?"*

The Learning Call

> *"I'm researching how Malaysian facilities approach condition monitoring. Could I get 15 minutes of your time to understand your process?"*

Tracking Your Numbers

Record every outreach attempt and its outcome in your CRM. After 3 months, you'll know your actual conversion ratios. These numbers replace guesswork with data and tell you exactly how much outreach you need to hit your targets.

Assignment Selling

Most vendors book a meeting and show up. Assignment selling means sending the prospect educational content BEFORE the meeting so they arrive informed, pre-qualified, and already trusting you. This is where the Content Engine and sales process connect.

How It Works

Old approach: Prospect calls, asks for a quote. "Sure, I'll be right out." No idea how educated the prospect is. You spend the first 30 minutes explaining what your service IS.

New approach: "Of course I'd love to come out. But you're about to invest in something important and I want to make sure you get the most out of our meeting. I'm going to send you two things: a short guide on what to look for in a provider, and an article on how our approach works. Have a look before we meet — it'll make our conversation much more productive."

90% of prospects say yes. For the 10% who refuse: if a prospect won't spend 10 minutes becoming informed, they're almost certainly buying on price alone — and you rarely win on price. The assignment filters for quality.

What to Send

This is where your Big 5 blog posts become sales tools:

- **Pricing inquiry:** Send your "How Much Does [Service] Cost?" blog post
- **Comparing vendors:** Send your comparison article
- **First-time buyer:** Send your complete guide to choosing the right provider
- **Concerned about problems:** Send your limitations/problems article
- **Any prospect:** Send a relevant case study showing results at a similar facility

Why Teaching Gives You Authority

The rights of a teacher are greater than those of a salesperson. A teacher can assign homework. A teacher can set expectations. A teacher can say "you need to understand this before we proceed." A salesperson can only hope the prospect gives them time. Assignment selling shifts the dynamic from selling to teaching.

The Follow-Up After Sending

Call the morning of the meeting: "Did you get a chance to go through the guide I sent?" If yes: the meeting starts at a completely different level. If no: "Take 10 minutes, it'll make our meeting more productive." You've just established authority and filtered for seriousness.

Running the Meeting

Pre-Meeting Preparation

- Check their style in CRM. If unknown, observe in the first 60 seconds
- Research their company, recent projects, likely pain points
- Prepare your first-five-minutes sequence adjusted for their style
- Set your intention: "It's about them, not about me. Am I showing or claiming?"

The First Five Minutes

The first few minutes set the direction of the entire meeting. Plan them carefully:

6. Personal link: Comment on something about their facility or company. Genuine curiosity, not small talk.
7. Agenda statement: "I appreciate your time. Today I'd like to understand your approach and share how we've helped similar organisations. Sound good?"
8. Positioning statement: Lead with a RESULT, not a capability.
9. Stage-setting anecdote: One brief real story from a past project. Under 30 seconds.

10. The Big Question: “Tell me about how you currently manage your maintenance. What keeps you up at night?” Then shut up and listen.

Questions That Surface Real Needs

- “When was the last time you had a comprehensive assessment done?”
- “How do you currently prioritise what to inspect or maintain?”
- “Have you had any unplanned incidents in the last 12 months?”
- “What does your insurance or regulator require?”
- “If you could wave a magic wand, what would you change about your current programme?”

Buying signals to listen for:

- **“We’ve been meaning to do something about that”** — recognised need
- **“Our insurance company has been asking”** — external pressure = urgent
- **“We had an incident last year”** — pain point with emotional weight
- **“Current vendor’s reports aren’t useful”** — competitor weakness

> *The “What else?” technique: Keep asking until the client has nothing left. The real problem usually surfaces second or third, not first.*

Framing the Problem

Before offering a solution, reframe the problem in a way the client hasn’t seen it. This is what separates a one-off transaction from a long-term relationship.

DON’T	DO
Client: “We need annual inspection for compliance.” Vendor: “We can do that for RM 12,000.”	Adviser: “Compliance is the minimum. What you’re really managing is the risk of unplanned downtime that could cost RM 200K per incident. The inspection is just the detection mechanism. The real value is a prioritised programme that prevents failures.”

How Framing Shifts by Style

- **Director:** Business impact in one line. “This isn’t an inspection cost. It’s a downtime prevention investment.”
- **Socialiser:** Vision and status. “Imagine presenting a proactive risk management programme to your board.”
- **Relater:** Reassurance. “You’ve been doing the right things. This is about adding a layer that catches what the current approach can’t.”

- **Thinker:** Technical logic chain. Walk through the failure modes, detection gaps, and risk quantification methodically.

Naming and Claiming

When you sense something unspoken, name it. Use softening phrases:

- "I might be reading this wrong, but it sounds like the real concern isn't the inspection — it's that previous reports weren't actionable enough for your team."
- "At the risk of overstepping, I'm noticing that the bigger issue here might be budget timing rather than technical need."
- "You've probably thought about this already, but the equipment age combined with the load increase creates a specific risk window."

Envisioning the Future State

Help them see what "good" looks like before you ask for commitment. This creates emotional buy-in.

"Imagine if every quarter, you had a dashboard showing the health trend of every critical asset. You'd know exactly which equipment is degrading, what your maintenance window is, and what to tell your insurance company. That's what a programme looks like after 12 months."

How the vision resonates by style:

- **Director:** The outcome. "No surprises, no shutdowns, predictable maintenance spend."
- **Socialiser:** The status. "Your management report will show a proactive, data-driven programme."
- **Relater:** The stability. "Routine, predictable, no disruptions to your team's workflow."
- **Thinker:** The logic. "Data-driven decisions replacing reactive maintenance. Full traceability from assessment to action."

Giving Advice Without Losing the Client

DON'T	DO
"Your approach is fundamentally flawed. You should have addressed this years ago."	"Based on what we've seen, there are areas that could use attention. Let me walk you through options and you decide what makes sense."

Advise clients like you're helping your parents — respectful, honest, always their decision.

The Disarmament Principle

When a prospect asks "why should I choose you?" the instinct is to pitch. The better move: disarm first.

"To be frank, we may not be the best fit for you. You've seen our proposal and others. Based on everything you've heard, do you feel we're the right choice?"

This produces a dramatically more honest answer than any further selling would. If they hesitate, you've surfaced a real objection you can address. If they say yes, they've just sold themselves.

The Assignment Selling Follow-Up

After the meeting, instead of the generic "just checking in" email, send targeted content:

"During our meeting, you mentioned concerns about [specific issue]. I've attached an article explaining [relevant topic]. Give it a look and I'll call Thursday to discuss."

This reaffirms expertise, addresses specific concerns, and gives a reason for the follow-up call that isn't "please buy from me."

Winning the Work

Style-Adapted Proposals

The same content framework, radically different presentation:

Style	Format	What They Read First
Director	2 pages max. Price upfront.	Price and timeline
Socialiser	Visual. Testimonials.	Who else you've worked with
Relater	Detailed process. Reassuring.	Implementation process
Thinker	Comprehensive. Methodology.	Technical approach

Universal proposal principles regardless of style:

- Lead with THEIR problem statement using THEIR words from the meeting
- Show you understood their constraints (budget, timelines, compliance deadlines)
- Present the service tier that fits their situation, with clear outcomes
- Include 2–3 anonymised case references — evidence, not claims
- No surprises — everything should have been discussed verbally first

Handling "Price Is Too High"

- **Director:** What you get for the money. "Our price includes [differentiator] and [differentiator]. The next cheapest option doesn't."
- **Socialiser:** Relationship reassurance. "I hear you. Let me see what I can do. The quality won't change."
- **Relater:** Process comfort. "Let's look at a phased approach that fits your budget cycle."
- **Thinker:** Cost-benefit data. "Here's the comparison: our fee vs. the average cost of the problem we're preventing."

When You Lose

- Debrief within 48 hours: "To help us improve, could you share what tipped the decision?"
- Push past vague reasons ("better chemistry") to find the real issue

- Common real reasons: didn’t demonstrate understanding, weak team impression, price without justification, didn’t differentiate
- Track patterns across losses in your CRM
- Don’t burn the bridge — incumbent vendors fail. Follow up in 6 months

SECTION 6: DELIVERING & GROWING

During Delivery

- Confirm appointments 24 hours before. Send agendas before meetings.
- Provide same-day summaries after every site visit or key meeting.
- Don't oversell in your deliverables. If something is fine, say so. The client who reads "all normal" trusts your findings on items that DO have issues.
- Include a "What's Next" section in every report — genuine guidance, not a sales pitch.
- Help them USE what you deliver — coach them on presenting findings to their boss, prioritising actions, justifying budget.

Style-Adapted On-Site Behaviour

During inspections you'll deal with multiple styles on the same client team:

- **Director (Plant Manager):** Brief them first. "We'll be done by 3pm. Summary by end of day."
- **Socialiser (Friendly Operator):** Chat with them. Let them show you around. They'll give you better access and insider info.
- **Relater (Maintenance Tech):** Ask "Is now a good time?" before accessing equipment. Explain what you're doing. Don't disrupt their routine.
- **Thinker (Engineering Manager):** Show calibration certificates. Explain methodology before starting. Let them observe.

The 4 Levels of Client Relationship

Level	Description	Revenue Implication
1. Service Provider	You do what you're asked.	One-off, easily replaced
2. Capable Expert	They trust your judgment.	Repeat work, some flexibility
3. Valued Resource	They seek your input beyond scope.	Annual contracts, premium pricing
4. Trusted Adviser	They involve you in strategy.	Multi-year partnerships, referrals

Post-Delivery Follow-Up Cadence

- **30 days:** "Have you had a chance to action the priority findings?"
- **90 days:** "Did the remedial work resolve the issues we identified?"
- **Ongoing:** Share relevant updates. "New regulation published that might affect your next cycle. Happy to brief your team."

A relationship plan says: “Send case study in January. Follow up on remedial progress in February. Alert about new requirement in March. By Q2, they’re calling us.” A sales plan says: “Contact them when we need work.” The difference is who initiates.

The Portal Service Strategy

Every technical services company needs a “portal service” — a diagnostic assessment that’s affordable, in the client’s best interest, gives you access to multiple stakeholders during delivery, answers an immediate question, and naturally leads to bigger work.

The Conversion Path

Diagnostic assessment (RM 15–25K) → report shows issues → client wants ongoing monitoring → annual programme (RM 30–60K) → multi-facility rollout (RM 80–150K+) → training for client’s staff → long-term strategic partnership.

Growing Accounts

The Trust-Transfer Problem

Trust is personal, not institutional. Your great relationship with one site manager doesn’t automatically transfer to a different site or different decision maker. Three types of expansion:

- **Expand (higher tier, same person):** Upgrading a client from basic to comprehensive. Easiest.
- **Broaden (same tier, new person):** Getting introduced from facility manager to regional head. Medium.
- **Diversify (new person, new site):** Multi-facility rollout across different locations with different teams. Hardest.

Asking for Referrals

Timing: only after delivering results they’re happy with. Phrasing adapted by style:

- **Director:** Direct. “Who else in your network could use this?”
- **Socialiser:** Enthusiastic. “You’ve seen the results — anyone else who’d benefit?”
- **Relater:** Gentle. “If you think any colleagues would find this helpful, I’d welcome an introduction whenever it feels right.”
- **Thinker:** Factual. “Based on the results, similar facilities would benefit from the same assessment. Any you’d recommend?”

Price Increase Conversations

- **Director:** Direct. “Costs increased due to [reason]. New rate is RM X. Same quality, same speed.”
- **Socialiser:** Frame positively. “We’ve upgraded equipment and capabilities. Better results. New rate reflects the improvement.”

- **Relater:** Reassuring. “Everything stays the same — same team, same process, same relationship. The adjustment is modest.”
- **Thinker:** Full breakdown. “Equipment costs up X%, certification up Y%. New rate of RM Z. Attached: comparison showing value per inspection point.”

When to Turn Down Small Work

Every small one-off you accept keeps your average fee low and occupies time that could pursue larger programme work. Know the difference between a portal project (strategic entry point — worth it) and small work that has no path to something bigger (usually not worth it unless you need cashflow).

SECTION 7: YOUR 12-MONTH PLAN

Growth Formula Targets

Variable	Current	3-Month	6-Month	12-Month
N (Network)	___	___	___	___
B (% Buyers)	___	___	___	___
F (Avg Fee)	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___
Revenue	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___	RM ___

The 3 Things to Do Tomorrow

11. Write one Big 5 blog post. Start with cost or problems — the topics nobody else will touch. Distribute through the content engine. Grows N (new eyeballs) and B (trust through teaching).
12. Apply to speak at one industry event in the next 3 months. Grows N (room full of buyers) and B (speaker = expert).
13. Send one value-add email to 10 target contacts — not a pitch, but useful content (compliance checklist, case study, blog post link). Grows N and demonstrates the “go first” principle.

QUICK REFERENCE

Designed for pre-meeting prep. Print this section and keep it in your bag.

60-Second Style Identification

14. Fast-paced/assertive (Direct) or slow-paced/reserved (Indirect)?
15. Task-focused (Guarded) or people-focused (Open)?

	Task-Focused	People-Focused
Fast-Paced	DIRECTOR: Decisive, impatient	SOCIALISER: Enthusiastic, big-picture
Slow-Paced	THINKER: Analytical, cautious	RELATER: Patient, consensus-seeking

Style Warnings

- **Socialiser:** They'll say yes enthusiastically then delay paperwork. Get commitments in writing.
- **Relater:** "Let me think about it" may mean no. Gently check.
- **Thinker:** May keep asking for data to delay decisions. "Once you have this, will you have enough to decide?"
- **Director:** If you're slow, they move on. Respond same day.

Pre-Meeting Checklist

- Check their style in CRM
- Research: company, recent changes, equipment age, industry context
- Prepare first five minutes for their style
- Set intention: "It's about them, not me. Am I showing or claiming?"
- Bring: company profile, relevant case study, sample report (for Thinkers)

Self-Test Before Any Marketing Material

- Am I telling them I'm good, or showing evidence?
- Is this about my company, or about the client?
- Would I trust a company that said this about themselves?
- Is there a specific result or number I could use instead of a general claim?
- Am I giving something valuable, or just asking for something?

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